

Set the boundary and the perspectives

CASE

GROUP

DATE

1 What is part of this system, and what is not

The test for both columns: *would including this change what you would do about the problem?* Everything left out carries a reason, and is marked **F** fixed, **O** out of reach, or **I** irrelevant.

PART OF THIS SYSTEM	NEXT TO IT, BUT NOT PART OF IT	F	O	I
		☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐

2 The layers

What scopes of decision are at work here? Name them, starting with the one whose decisions reach furthest. Three to five, and five is the cap.

1		WHY THIS IS THE WIDEST	
2			
3			
4			
5		WHY THIS IS THE NARROWEST	

Two layers is allowed only with a line saying why this case has no third scope of decision. An actor that seems to need two layers is usually two actors.

3 The actor types

What kinds of actor are there in this case? At most five, and no more than one type per three actors. An actor that seems to need two types usually means the type list is wrong.

A	B	C	D	E

4 The actors, and what each one holds

Past roughly fifteen actors, either the granularity or the boundary has gone wrong

Who can act in this system, or is acted upon by it? One line each, in one layer, with one type. Include those affected by the system but not involved in it.

ACTOR	LAYER	TYPE	AUTHORITY	MONEY	DELIVERY	INFORMATION	ACCESS	LEGITIMACY	ATTENTION

Who needs each holding from whom is on the back, and it is asked only for the actors the allocation in zone 5 points to.

Who decides, who depends, who disagrees

5

Authority, responsibility, and accountability

Take the decision the desired change depends on. Name the layer that holds each of the three for that decision. "Nobody" is an allowed answer, and usually the most interesting one.

THE DECISION _____

AUTHORITY _____

RESPONSIBILITY _____

ACCOUNTABILITY _____

If the case turns on more than one decision, do this for at most two, and say which.

6

Who needs what from whom

Usually three to six actors

Asked only for the actors zone 5 points to: any actor in a layer holding authority, responsibility, or accountability for that decision, and anyone who holds something those actors need. Every other actor keeps the ticks on the front and nothing here, and that blank is a state rather than an omission.

ACTOR	WHAT THEY HOLD	WHO NEEDS IT FROM THEM, AND FOR WHAT

7

How the actors see the problem

At least two that genuinely conflict; five is plenty

What does each actor take the problem to be, and what does that follow from? In that actor's own terms. One of these is the description already on the step 1 sheet. Nothing here asks whether a view is correct.

ACTOR	WHAT THEY TAKE THE PROBLEM TO BE	EVIDENCED OR	
		INFERRED	READ FROM WHAT?

An inferred line names what it is read from and what would show it wrong. A line that can name neither is a guess and stays out. Motive is always a guess.

8

Who is not in this list, and why not?

The gate: the step is complete when

- ☐ What is excluded is stated, with a reason.
- ☐ The actors include those affected but not involved.
- ☐ Every actor sits in one layer and carries one type.
- ☐ For every actor, what they hold is recorded. For the actors the dependency question applies to, who needs each of those holdings from them is recorded as well.
- ☐ Which layer can take the decision, which is tasked with carrying the decision out, and which answers for the result, are each named or recorded as nobody.
- ☐ At least two different descriptions of the problem are recorded.
- ☐ The situation sketch has been drawn at the start, revisited and restructured at the end, and its three sentences written.

What the allocation in zone 5 usually shows

- All three in one layer.** Concentrated, and rarer than it looks. Step 12 then has one target and the ask can be simple.
- Authority in one layer, responsibility in another.** The common case in multi-level governance. An intervention aimed only at the responsible layer changes how the thing is done, never the rule under which it is done.
- Accountability somewhere else, or nowhere.** Expect blame to move and correction to be slow. That is a balancing loop, and it belongs on the mapping in step 5.

Before you finish, go back to the sketch with the second colour, rearrange it, and write its three sentences.